

DEFERRED and an unstated task both take the family's neutral ramp. The key now names the neutral, and a deferred bar carries a dashed edge — a cue that spends no hue, so it survives a palette that has no hue to spend.

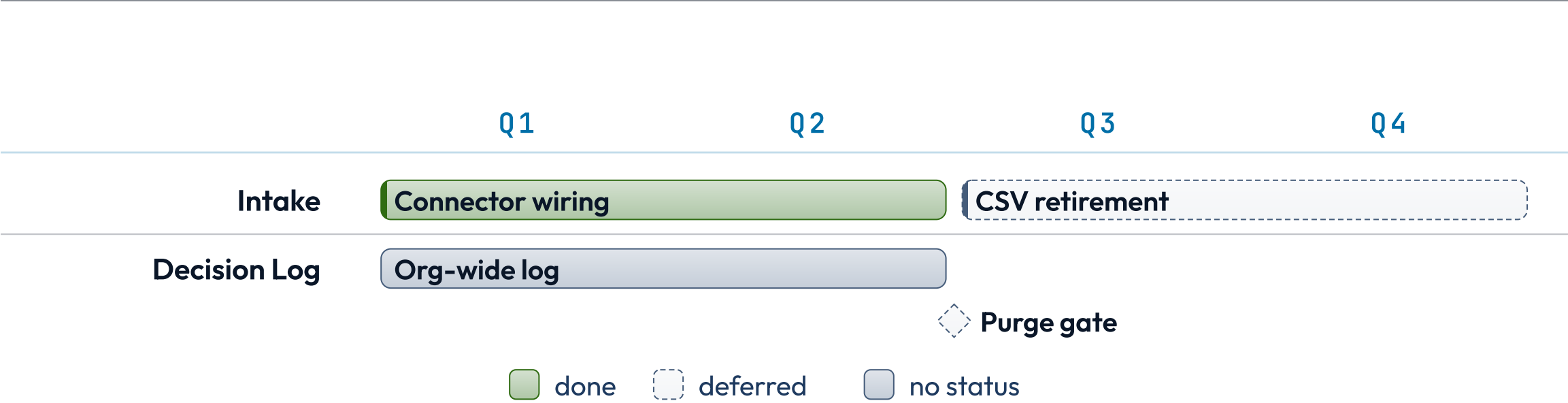
FEATURE DEMO • GANTT STATUS

**"We pushed this" and "nobody
said" are not the same bar.**

2026 Q1 .. 2026 Q4

Two neutrals, and the key named one.

Org-wide log has no status; *CSV retirement* and the *Purge gate* diamond are deferred. Only *deferred* ever had a chip.



Dashed bar and dashed diamond are deferred; the solid bar nobody labeled

Read the key, then the bars.

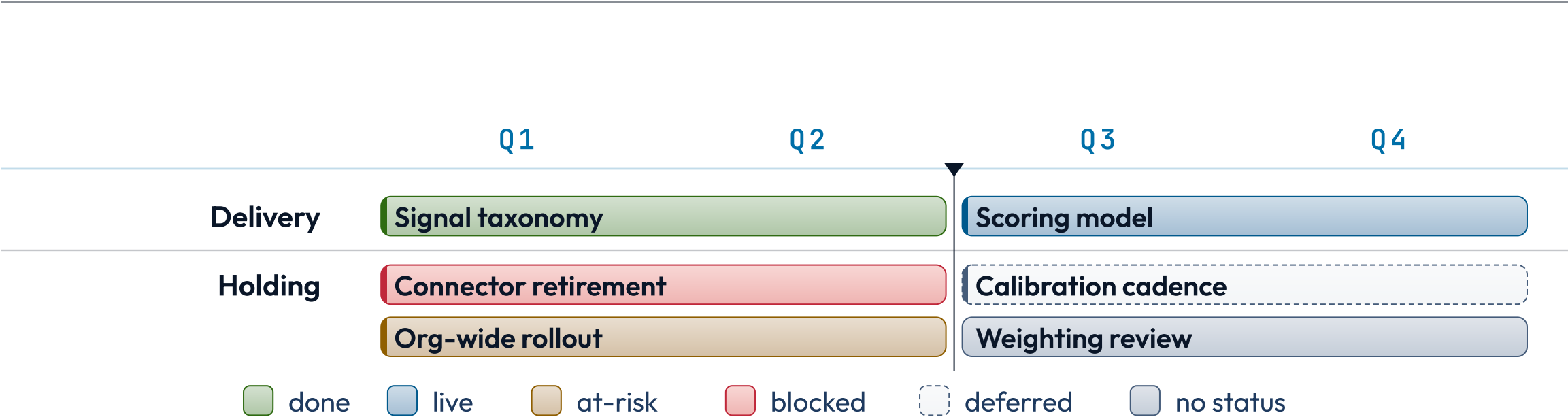
The chip without a hue is `no status` — the bar nobody labeled. It appears only when a chart carries an unstated task *and* already draws a key.

- The dash, not a shade
 - `deferred` keeps its hollow body and gains `stroke-dasharray`. Opacity alone was 18% of a ramp that is already a pale tint — a difference to be hunted for rather than seen.
- The neutral has a name now
 - A chip with no status falls to the swatch's own neutral fallback, so it cannot impersonate a declared one. `unscaled` is deliberately not keyed: `lint:deck` already names that cause, and one chip carries one meaning.

2026 Q1 .. 2026 Q4 today Q3

The full ramp, so the dash has neighbors.

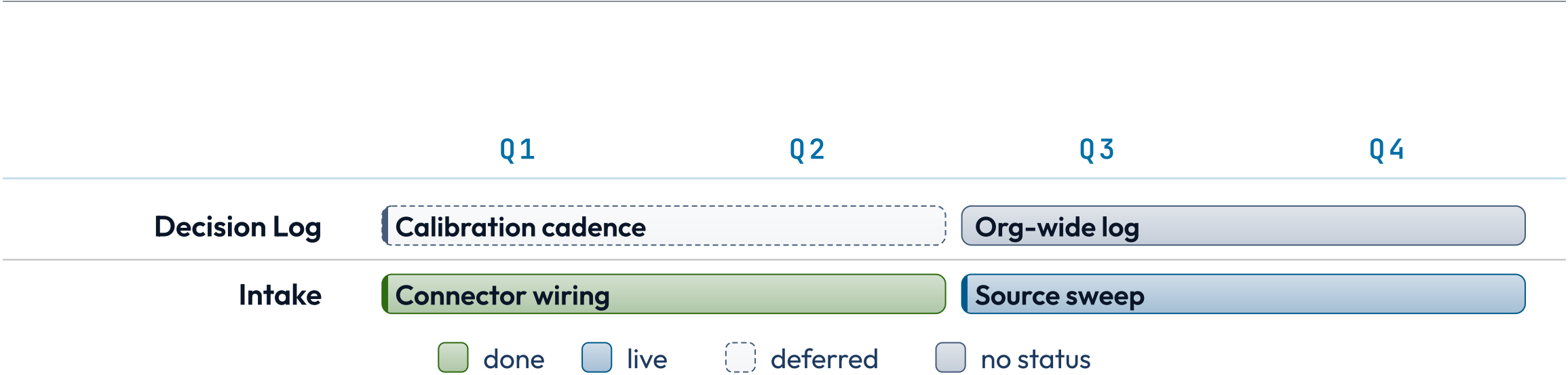
Five ramps carry ten status words, so some share. A status and the absence of one must not.



2026 Q1 .. 2026 Q4

Side by side in one lane is where the old cue failed.

Two bars on the same row, both neutral, one declared and one not. Opacity alone had to carry that; now the edge does.



Why a dash rather than one more neutral.

Render this deck under `theme: a11y-achromatopsia` and four of the five ramps resolve to a gray — `info` keeps a blue axis. `deferred` and an unstated bar both land on the mute ramp there, so between those two the dash is the whole distinction.

- The channels a hue does not reach
 - The four a11y palettes, grayscale print, a photocopied handout, and the `print` finish. Each one is a place where "the paler bar" stops being a distinction a reader can make.
- Why the numbers are CSS pixels
 - Every gantt mark inherits `vector-effect: non-scaling-stroke`, which re-scopes the dash *array* as well as the stroke width. So `4 2.5` is 4px on and 2.5px off on a 480-unit landscape `viewBox` and a 300-unit portrait one alike — one physical pattern, not two.

#2255

The cue that costs no hue
is the one that survives
the channel that has none.

*A second shade of neutral reads as the first
shade of neutral in grayscale print, on an
achromatopsia palette, and on a photocopied
handout. A dash reads as a dash in all three.*